Welcome to the LVNA

Villager

The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

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Monthly Meeting Wednesday, March 9th

At 7:00 pm in the Lakewood Park Building

This month's Guest:

LVNA Volunteers !

President's Column

-Fred Fowler



Greetings Neighbors!

Passing the Torch

This month it will be time to select new leaders for the LVNA as we leave 2015 behind and begin a new year for our organization. The March meeting will (most likely) consist of elections followed by a Pizza party. We'll have a "changing of the guard" where old LVNA officers will be thanked and new (or returning) ones welcomed and congratulated. After that, the new President and the incoming board will get down to the business of shepherding the neighborhood through another year.

As I wrote a month or two ago, I've been through this process several times before. I was first elected to the LVNA presidency on a March evening exactly 20 years ago. I served during the 1996 LVNA year and also the 1997 LVNA year. I had a great time talking about "beautiful Lakewood Village" and giving the neighborhood a voice and a presence in the broader community.

That talk had an effect. When Phyllis and I bought our home on Lakebird drive in 1995, the house had sat vacant for more than a year. Lakewood Village was known as the "low rent" part of Sunnyvale. By the time I was finished talking about "beautiful Lakewood Village", realtors were advertising Lakewood Village homes for sale in the San Jose Mercury News. When the housing boom hit Silicon Valley in the late 1990s, Lakewood Village caught the wave and saw home prices double and (Continued. *on Page 2)*

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LVNA Opportunity



March is the time to elect new LVNA Board members. I hope that there are more Lakewood residents that would like to get involved in the coordination of the LVNA events.

The LVNA Board is the foundation for establishing the LVNA Monthly meetings, Dumpster Day, LVNA Christmas Parade, and other neighborhood events.

If you wish to become involved in supporting your neighborhood and would consider being nominated for a LVNA Board position, please contact any of the LVNA Board members. Send an email to sunnyphyl@gmail.com or drop a note at 921 Lakebird Drive. **LVNA Board elections will take place at the March 9th meeting**. ◆

Extra: Walkers Needed!



Start the new year out right by committing to a walk once a month delivering newsletters. I have two routes in need of walkers. The first route is all of Twinlake. The second route is the back half of Lakewood, from Meadowlake to Lakehaven. If interested in either of these routes, **please call Wendy Stanley at 408-745-1331**. ◆

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President's Column

(Continued from page 1)



The homeowners in our neighborhood got to participate in the boom instead of being left out.

The LVNA has a rich history of neighborhood leadership. Back when I was president the first time we were blessed with strong leaders who took on major problems and solved them.

Two very special people, Mel and Elena Anderson, made it their business to raise the money needed to publish the newsletter. For years Mel would sell advertising and collect payments from local vendors, while Elena kept the books for us. They were the solid foundation that many neighborhood initiatives were built on. I always tried to find ways to thank them for their selfless service, but somehow I was never really able to do it. They saw that playing their role was thanks enough, and no other thanks were needed.

Another special person was Jessica Lee. She was one of the LVNA founders (along with Judy Fernandez) and served as LVNA president during the famous "graffiti wars" of the mid-1990s. She is noteworthy for facing down a City of Sunnyvale park employee who was threatening to have our volunteer (Gene Goldsmith) arrested for painting out graffiti on the Lakewood Park building. She straightened herself up to the full (not very tall) height, looked the park guy straight in the eye and told him, "If you are going to arrest Gene you'll have to arrest me too!" Thanks to her, the City became the LVNA's ally in the graffiti struggle instead of its adversary. Instead of equating the painting over of tags with putting the tags there in the first place (which the City formerly did) .

Jessica got city hall to realize how silly that policy was. Thanks in no small part to her, the war on graffiti was finally won, and we have our clean buildings, fences and signs as proof of that victory.

There are many more stories to tell. Craig Crawford served as LVNA president just before me and helped introduce me to the many issues we were facing. Jim and Helen Lane were "Mr. and Mrs. Dumpster Day" for many years and organized our annual neighborhood clean-up. Rick Flovin took up the burden of being LVNA president after me and did a fine job. I can go on and on.

I'm telling you about these people because it is important to understand who has come before. It is also important to understand that time moves on. Elena Andersen passed away in 2014. The last I heard, Mel is living in Florida and suffering from Alzheimer's. Jessica Lee served on the Sunnyvale School Board after leading the LVNA, but no longer lives in the neighborhood. Craig and Leah Crawford retired and moved to Alaska several years ago. Jim and Helen Lane passed away a few years ago.

Times change...

It is time for me to lay down the presidency of the LVNA. It is time for me to move on and join the ranks of the people I've described. I've been at this for 20 years now, off and on. It is time for new blood and new energy.

The great thing about Lakewood Village is that new leaders always come forward! In 1996 I stepped up and took over from Craig Crawford, who was burned out and needed a rest. 20 years later it is time for someone to step up and take over from me. I'm burned out and need a rest.
Accepting responsibility has its rewards. After all, leading the LVNA put me on a path that lead me to being the Mayor of Sunnyvale. There have been other rewards that are perhaps less visible but much more valuable to me. If I were 20 years younger, I would do it all again.

I've had my day. It is time for me to make room for the next generation of leadership.

Please come to the March meeting, put your name on the ballot and get yourself elected. If you re the right kind of person, you will never regret it.

Thanks, whoever you are, from the bottom of my heart.

--Fred ◆

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Sunday Services
9:30 a.m. Sunday School for all ages
11:00 a.m. Worship Service

Wednesday
7:00 p.m. Corporate Prayer Meeting





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Tips to Help Sell Your Home

Let us help you make the best first impression you can. Call us and let our experience work for you when it comes to increasing 'curb appeal' and attracting buyers quickly.

Note: Do cosmetic things first and avoid making major changes unless they will increase the value of your home more than the cost of the improvement.



Theresa Loya
408-209-1426

Alan Feldman
408-205-4250
BRE#01323368

Outside

1. Invest in landscaping where it can be seen at first sight.
2. Cut back overgrown shrubbery that looks scraggly or keeps light out of the house.
3. Paint your house if necessary. This can probably do more for curb appeal than any other factor.
4. Consider putting flowers outside, near the front door.
5. Repaint the front door if needed.

Kitchen

6. The kitchen is the most important room in the house. Make it bright and attractive. If dull, paint cabinets and put up perky new curtains.
7. Clean the ventilating hood in the kitchen.
8. If the kitchen floor is badly worn, put down new flooring. Replace any broken or chipped tiles.
9. Remove any appliances that you keep on your counters. Clean counters make the room look larger.

Bathroom

10. Repair dripping faucets.
11. Use special cleaning products to remove stains from toilets, bathtubs, sinks and showers.
12. If sinks and bathtub drain too slowly, unclog them.

When Your House is Being Shown

13. Keep room draperies and shades open to let light in. it makes the room appear larger.
14. Have all lights turned on during the showing.
15. Take pets outdoors when your house is being shown.

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Free Tax Help

Tax Day is **Monday, April 18**! Need some help with your taxes? Here are two options.

FREE Tax Preparation Assitance

When: Saturdays, March 12th & 26th
Time: 10:00 am—4:00 pm
Where: Columbia Neighborhood Center
Morse room, 785 Morse Ave

Tax-Aid, a non-profit organization, will provide trained volunteers to assist families with a maximum gross income of $54,000 annually with completing 2015 taxes. Participants do not have to be US citizens, and Spanish translators will be available.

This is a walk-in service only, with NO appointments necessary. Participants will be requird to bring IDs and other documents for futher information visit: **www.tx-aid.org** or call (408) 730-7800.

Volunteer Income Tax Assistance (VITA)

When: Mondays, February 22 - April 11
Time: 5-8 pm
Where: Sunnyvale Public Library Technology Center

This program offers free IRS-certified income tax preparation to individuals who earned $58,000 or less in 2015. Site open on a first-come, first-served basis and functions as a drop-off site for tax returns.

Learn more about the VOTA program: go to **www.uwsv.org\free-tax-help**

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Discover and Go Free Museum Pass Program

Looking for a free, fun, educational outing for the family or an excursion for out-of-town guests? Sunnyvale Public Library has joined with other libraries to offer Discover & Go passes for Library cardholders to many Northern California museums and cultural institutions. Discover & Go is a new service that allows Sunnyvale Library cardholders to print passes online for specific museums. Each Discover & Go pass expires the day after the reservation date. Library cardholders can reserve up to two passes at one time.

Some of the museums that are available for free or at discounted prices include: The Marine Mammal Center, Charles M. Schulz Museum, The Tech Museum and the Pacific Pinball Museum.

The full list of participating museums that are available to Sunnyvale Library cardholders can be found by going to :
https://sunnyvalelibrary.discoverandgo.net

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Patrick Ball
Celtic Bard Brought To Life



When: March 12th @ 8 pm
Cost: General Admission $29.00
and Student/Senior 60+ $23.00
Where: Sunnyvale Theatre
550 E. Remington Drive
Sunnyvale, CA 94087

Just in time for St Patrick's Day. Here is a chance to experience the beauty of Irish music A Sunnyvale favorite, Patrick Ball is one of the premier Celtic harp players in the world and a captivating spoken word artist. In playing the ancient, legendary brass-strung harp of Ireland with its crystalline, bell-like voice, and in performing marvelous tales of wit and enchantment, he not only brings new life to two cherished traditions, but blends them in concert to create "a richly theatrical and hauntingly beautiful performance."



In this new show, Ball not only carries on two of the richest traditions of Celtic culture, but blends them in concert to create "a warm and magical performance.

Call (408) 730-7725 for more information ◆

Pet Assisted Therapy



What: Love on a Leash
When: March 24th
Time: 6:00 – 7:00 pm,
Room opens at 5:30 pm
Where:
Humane Society Silicon Valley
901 Ames Ave, Milpitas

Do you have a calm & friendly cat, dog, or rabbit who enjoys new people and places?
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***No pets, please at your 1st meeting.**



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Police Blotter

Commercial Burglary – 1000 Blk. Escalon
Tuesday February 2nd @ 6:28 pm
Officers responded to a report of a burglary which just occurred at a construction site. Officers determined copper piping had been stolen and the suspects fled in a truck. Officers broadcasted a description of the truck, and shortly thereafter Santa Clara PD reported locating the truck in their city. The suspects fled but were captured after a foot chase. Both suspects were arrested and booked into County Jail. The copper piping was recovered.

Emergency Medical Response – 1300 Blk. Dunnock
Saturday February 6th @ 1:42 am
DPS personnel responded to a residence on a report of a subject unconscious and not breathing. Patrol officers were first to arrive, found the patient in cardiac arrest, and applied a shock with an AED. Fire personnel and paramedics arrived and delivered another shock. The patient had regained a pulse and was breathing, and was transported to the hospital.

Major Injury Accident – Wolfe & Kifer
Tuesday February 9th @ 8:56 am
DPS personnel responded to the area of Wolfe and Kifer on a report of a bicyclist down in the roadway. Personnel located the bicyclist who was semi-conscious and suffered head injuries. It was determined the bicyclist lost control and fell and was not stuck by a vehicle. The bicyclist was transported to the hospital and was in stable condition.

Robbery – 1000 Blk. Reed Terr.
Sunday, Feb 14th @ 7:58 pm
The victim posted property for sale on Craigslist. The unknown suspects came to the victim's residence to pick up the property. Once the property was loaded into the suspect's vehicle, the victim was physically assaulted and the suspects fled without paying for the property.

Felon in Possession of a Firearm – 1200 Blk. Wildwood
Thursday February 25th @ 11:51 pm
Officers located a subject who had outstanding arrest warrants. The suspect fled on foot and into a local bar. The suspect was found hiding in a storage cabinet and was in possession of a firearm. The suspect was arrested and booked into County Jail.

Haz Mat – 1095 Dunford
Monday February 29th @ 3:18 pm
DPS personnel responded on a report of a dumpster fire. It was determined not to be a fire, but a chemical reaction due to items thrown into the dumpster. The chemical reaction caused a plume of smoke. Some residences in the area were evacuated and nearby schools were sheltered in place. The DPS Haz Mat team monitored the situation until the chemicals were contained and removed.

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Public Safety - Non-emergency	730-7100
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Noise complaints—Desk Officer	730-7110
Neighborhood Preservation Complaints on decrepit fences, , weeds, illegal home businesses or rentals	730-7610
Animal Control	730-7178
Public Works- sidewalks, trees, streetlights, etc.	730-7505
Nuisance Vehicle Hotline	730-7706
Drug Hotline	245-3784
Graffiti Hotline & Shopping Cart Pickup	730-7680

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Lakewood Side - 3/15 & 3/29 & 4/12

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To submit articles or letters for publication, please contact the editor before the 28th of each month
Send your document or inquiry to Phyllis Fowler: sunnyphyl@gmail.com